

Vermont DP T1 Questionnaire

Hello, my name is [fill INAM]. I'm calling from the Office of Survey Research at the University of Texas at Austin. We're conducting a survey of what Vermonters think about the ways in which the state should meet its future electricity needs. The study is being conducted for Department of Public Service of the State of Vermont, which is very interested in your opinions. Your telephone number has been selected at random.

Is this a private residence?

May I speak with the person 18 years or older in your household who most recently had a birthday?

If R IS the person over 18 with the most recent birthday, skip to 1. If R is NOT the person over 18 with the most recent birthday, restart with the person who is:

Hello, my name is [fill INAM]. I'm calling from the Office of Survey Research at the University of Texas at Austin. We're conducting a survey of what Vermonters think about the ways in which the state should meet its future energy needs. The study is being conducted for Department of Public Service of the State of Vermont, which is very interested in your opinions. Your telephone number has been selected at random.

It's very important to us to get a picture of what *all* Vermonters think about these issues, so we hope you can spare a few minutes of your time to share your opinions, even if these are issues you haven't thought much about.

IF R agrees to participate:

Great! We're very interested in knowing what you think. If we get to a question where you don't have an opinion, just say so. All your answers will be kept completely confidential. If you have any questions regarding this study, you can contact O'Neil Provost at the Office of Survey Research at 1-800-824-4761.

Again this is a survey about how Vermonters would like to see the State meet its future electricity needs, over the next ten years. These are issues many people haven't thought much about, but we're interested in hearing what you have to say regardless. If we come to a question where you don't have much opinion about it, just say so, and we'll move on to the next one.

Policy items

1. To begin with, on a 0 to 10 scale, where 0 is "not at all", 10 is "a great deal," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much would you say you care about how the electricity you use is produced?
2. Next, some people think Vermont should meet as much of its electricity needs as possible by increasing the efficiency with which Vermont consumers use electricity. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think Vermont should meet its electricity needs entirely by generating or buying more electricity. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4, and of course other people have opinions at other points between 1 and 7. Where would you place yourself on this scale, or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

And what percentage of the electricity Vermont consumes would you *like* to see come from each of the following generation related sources over the next 10 years? (Please answer in numbers between 0 and 100.) READ WHOLE SET ALOUD 1st.

- | | |
|------------------------------------|-------|
| 3. Wind | _____ |
| 4. Oil | _____ |
| 5. Natural gas | _____ |
| 6. Coal | _____ |
| 7. Nuclear | _____ |
| 8. Solar | _____ |
| 9. Hydro | _____ |
| 10. Wood | _____ |
| 11. Methane from farms or landfill | _____ |

~~12. Some people think Vermont's electric utilities should meet the state's future energy needs by contracting to buy electricity from other providers. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think Vermont's electric utilities should meet the state's future electricity needs by building their own facilities. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. Again people who are exactly in-between are at point 4, and again of course other people have opinions at other points between 1 and 7. Where would you place yourself on this scale?~~

Next we'd like know how strongly you agree or disagree with each of the following statements. Here's the first:

13. Vermont should continue to purchase electricity from Hydro Quebec. Would you ...

agree strongly,
agree somewhat
neither agree nor disagree
disagree somewhat,
disagree strongly,
or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

14. Vermont should continue to purchase electricity from the Vermont Yankee nuclear power plant. Would you ...

agree strongly,
agree somewhat
neither agree nor disagree
disagree somewhat,
disagree strongly,
or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

15. Vermont should continue to purchase electricity from the Vermont based independent Power Producers, producing electricity from hydro and wood chips. Would you ...

agree strongly,
agree somewhat
neither agree nor disagree
disagree somewhat,
disagree strongly,

or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

~~16. The price Vermonters pay for electricity should be higher when the cost of generating it is higher and lower when the cost of generating it is lower. Would you ...~~

~~agree strongly,
agree somewhat
neither agree nor disagree
disagree somewhat,
disagree strongly,
or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?—~~

17. Vermont should require that a minimum percentage of the electricity sold to Vermonters come from renewable sources. Would you ... ?

agree strongly,
agree somewhat
neither agree nor disagree
disagree somewhat,
disagree strongly,
or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

18. If Vermont *were* to require that a minimum percentage of the electricity sold to Vermonters come from renewable sources, what percentage should that be? ____% (Please answer with a number between 0 and 100.) ?

~~19. And would you like to see the electricity used by Vermonters produced ... ?~~

~~Entirely inside Vermont
Mostly inside Vermont
About half and half, inside and outside Vermont
Mostly outside Vermont
Entirely outside Vermont~~

Here are some questions about the locations of electric generation facilities that could conceivably be built in Vermont. On a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is "strongly opposed," 10 is "strongly in favor," and 5 is exactly in the middle, how would you say you feel about having each of these types of facilities built in Vermont?

20. Facilities that produce electricity using wind.

21. Facilities that produce electricity using natural gas.

22. Facilities that produce electricity using biomass, like woodchips.

23. Facilities that produce electricity from hydropower.

24. Facilities that produce electricity from oil.

25. Facilities that produce electricity from landfill or farm methane

26. Some people would like to have electric bills that don't change too much from year to year, even if their electricity may wind up costing quite a bit more than the market price. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people would like to get their electricity at the market price, even if their bills may go up and down by quite a bit from year to year. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale? Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

27. Some people think that Vermont's electricity should be produced by a few large, centralized, plants. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think that it should be produced by smaller facilities, spread across the state. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. Where would you place yourself on this scale? Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

28. How strongly would you support or oppose a wind farm being built if it were visible from where you live? Would you ...

Support it strongly

Support it somewhat

Neither support nor oppose it

Oppose it somewhat

Oppose it strongly

Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

29. Over the next ten years would you like to see Vermont increase the funding for its energy efficiency program, decrease it, or keep it about the same level?

Increase it

Keep it about the same

Decrease it

Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

30. Over the next ten years would you like to see Vermont increase the percentage of electricity it uses that comes from renewable resources, decrease the percentage or keep it at about the same level?

Increase it

Keep it about the same

Decrease it

Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

31. How many dollars more per month would you be willing to pay, if necessary, for electricity that came entirely from sources that produced no greenhouse gases, other pollutants, or nuclear wastes? If you wouldn't be willing to pay any more for this, just say "zero."

 (Record number in

\$)

-

32. Now a question about *how* Vermont should invest in additional renewable resources, to the extent that it decides to do that. Some people think that the cost of additional renewable resources should be divided among all customers. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think individual customers should be asked how much electricity from renewable resources they would like to buy and that Vermont should only acquire enough renewable energy to meet that demand even though all would benefit. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. Where would you place yourself on this scale? Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Empirical premises

On a scale of a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is extremely *unfriendly* to the environment, 10 is extremely friendly to it, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how environmentally friendly or unfriendly would you say each of the following sources is?

- | | |
|------------------------------------|-------|
| 33. Wind | _____ |
| 34. Oil | _____ |
| 35. Natural gas | _____ |
| 36. Coal | _____ |
| 37. Nuclear | _____ |
| 38. Solar | _____ |
| 39. Hydro | _____ |
| 40. Wood | _____ |
| 41. Methane from farms or landfill | _____ |
| 42. Energy efficiency | _____ |

On another scale of 0 to 10, where 1 is extremely *unconcerned*, 10 is extremely concerned, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how concerned do you are you about each of the following?

- 43. Radioactive waste from nuclear power plants
- 44. Greenhouse gases produced by burning fuel to make electricity
- 45. Other air pollution produced by burning fuel to make electricity
- 46. Damage to river habitats from building hydro power facilities
- 47. The visual impact of wind farms on the scenery of Vermont

And on another scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is no threat at all, 10 is an extremely serious threat, and 5 is exactly in the middle, how much of a threat to Vermont's scenic beauty would you say is posed by locating each of the following electricity sources in Vermont?

- 48. A coal fired electric generating plant
- 49. A natural gas fired electric generating plant
- 50. A utility scale wind farm.
- 51. A residential scale wind farm
- 52. Electricity transmission lines

53. By about what percentage do you believe Vermont's need for electricity *could* be reduced by increasing the efficiency with which Vermont consumers use electricity by 2017? (Please answer with a number between 0 and 100percent) ____%

54. About what percentage of the electricity consumed by Vermonters would you say *could possibly* be provided by each of the following by 2017? (Please answer in numbers between 0 and 100.)

- | | |
|------------------------------------|-------|
| 55. Wind | _____ |
| 56. Oil | _____ |
| 57. Natural gas | _____ |
| 58. Coal | _____ |
| 59. Nuclear | _____ |
| 60. Solar | _____ |
| 61. Hydro | _____ |
| 62. Wood | _____ |
| 63. Methane from farms or landfill | _____ |

And how strongly would you agree or disagree with each of the following statements?

64. "Cleaner energy will cost more in the *short* run." Would you ...

agree strongly
agree somewhat
neither agree nor disagree,
disagree somewhat,
disagree strongly,
or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

65. "Cleaner energy will cost more in the *long* run." Would you ...

agree strongly
agree somewhat
neither agree nor disagree,
disagree somewhat,
disagree strongly,
or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

66. Some people think the weather of the past few decades is just an example of normal variation over time. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think the weather of the past decade is part of a lasting climate change. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale? Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

67. Some people think that human activity is responsible for any climate change that may be occurring. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think that any climate change that may be occurring is due to natural causes. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4. Where would you place yourself on this scale? Or wouldn't you have any opinion about that?

Values

68. Some people think that in choosing a source for electricity only the direct costs, like those of building and operating the power generation facility and the power lines, should be considered. Suppose these people are at one end of a 1-to-7 scale, at point 1. Other people think that indirect costs, like

those associated with pollution, greenhouse gas emissions, or nuclear wastes, should also be considered. Suppose these people are at the other end of the scale, at point 7. People who are exactly in-between are at point 4, and of course other people have opinions at other points between 1 and 7. Where would you place your views on this scale?

Thinking about the ways in which Vermont might meet its future electricity needs, please tell me how important each of the following goals is to you using a scale of 0 to 10, with 0 being not at all important and 10 being critically important.

- 69. Keeping electricity rates low for the consumer
- 70. Keeping electric rates stable for the consumer (Note: Use same term in 64 and 65.)
- 71. Reducing dependence on foreign energy sources
- 72. Minimizing air pollution
- 73. Using power produced in Vermont
- 74. Avoiding facilities that detract from the scenic beauty of Vermont
- 75. Reducing the emission of gases that may contribute to climate change
- 76. Having a reliable supply of electricity
- 77. Reducing radioactive wastes
- 78. Creating jobs in Vermont
- 79. Getting electricity from resources that will never be used up

Knowledge

Now we come to some factual questions to which not everyone may know the right answers. If we come to one to which you don't know the answer, just say so, and we'll move on to the next one.

80. Is the surcharge Vermonters pay on their electric bills for programs to reduce the need for electricity currently ...?

- Zero—there is no surcharge
- About .005 cents per kilowatt hour
- About .02 cents per kilowatt hour
- About .5cents per kilowatt hour
- About .75 cents per kilowatt hour

81. What effect have energy Vermont's energy efficiency program had on the annual **increase** in the amount of electricity used by Vermonter's? Has it

- Had almost no impact on the increase
- Reduced it by 20%
- Reduced it by 50%
- Reduced it by 70%
- Reduced it by 90%

82. Excluding Hydro Quebec, about what percentage of its electricity Does Vermont currently get from renewable resources?

- 5%
- 15%
- 25%

40%

83. And about what percentage of its electricity Does Vermont currently get from the Vermont Yankee nuclear plant?

5%
10%
20%
33%

84. About what percentage of its electricity does Vermont currently get from Hydro Quebec?

15%
33%
45%
60%

85. Roughly what percentage of Vermont's electricity is currently generated within Vermont?

12%
33%
55%
72%

86. How do Vermont's electricity rates compare with those of the rest of New England? Are they, on average,

Roughly 10%% higher
Roughly 20%% higher
About the same
Roughly 10% lower
Roughly 20% lower

87. What is the average electric bill for the typical Vermonter? Is it ...

Roughly \$60
Roughly \$80
Roughly \$120
Roughly \$180

88. Does Vermont's contract with the Vermont Yankee nuclear power plant expire in ...

2010
2012
2018
2025

Background (Bob/Will—Has this been updated yet?)

Finally, a few questions about you:

89. Which of the following best describes the highest level of education you have completed? [READ]

- 01 Less than high school
- 02 High school
- 03 Some university / college
- 04 University / college graduate
- 05 Some graduate work
- 06 Graduate degree
- 07 Other (specify: _____)
- VOLUNTEERED**
- 97 Refused/No answer

90. In what year were you born? _____

91. And what is your current employment status? Are you currently ... :

READ RESPONSES IN ORDER—CODE ONE ONLY

- | | | |
|---|---|-----------|
| 1 | Employed full-time | CONTINUE |
| 2 | Employed part-time | CONTINUE |
| 3 | Not employed, but actively looking for work; or | SKIP TO Q |
| 4 | Student | |
| 5 | Not actively looking for work | SKIP TO Q |
| 6 | Refused | SKIP TO Q |

92. (If employed in Q90) Which of the following best describes your employment?

- Self employed
- Business under 25 employees
- Business with 25 or more employees
- Government
- Other

93. Averaging over the whole year, about how much would you say your average monthly electric bill is?

94. Which of the following broad income categories best describes your total household income before taxes in 2006? Would it be ... : **READ RESPONSES IN ORDER—CODE ONE ONLY**

- 1 Less than \$25,000
- 2 Between \$25,000 and \$50,000
- 3 Between \$50,000 and \$75,000
- 4 Between \$75,000 and \$100,000, or
- 5 Between \$100,000 and \$125,000
- 6 Between \$125,000 and \$150,000
- 7 More than \$150,000
- 8 Refused/No answer
- 9 Don't know

95. In politics, people often talk about “liberal” and “conservative.” On a scale from 1 to 7, where 1 is extremely liberal, 7 is extremely conservative, and 4 is exactly in the middle, how liberal or conservative would you say you are, or wouldn’t you have any opinion about that?
96. And generally speaking, would say that you usually think of yourself as a Democrat, a Republican, an independent, or what?
97. Gender [by observation]

- 1 Male
2 Female

That was the last question. Now I have a special invitation for you. The Department of Public Service of the State of Vermont is sponsoring something called a Deliberative Poll of a random sample of Vermonters from all across the state. We are inviting people who have completed this interview to attend. On **Saturday and Sunday, November 3 and 4, on the University of Vermont campus in Burlington**, you will have a chance to discuss Vermont’s energy future and to question policy experts and policy makers about it.

We can offer a **payment of \$150** as a token of appreciation for your time, and **meals and lodging will be provided**. Most if the participants will stay at the Sheraton Hotel in Burlington, the rest at the Hampton Inn in Colchester, just north of Burlington. The event is carefully balanced, with all points of view represented and considered. We expect there to be a significant television and newspaper coverage. You would need to arrive by **9:00 a.m. on the 3rd** and would be free to leave by **4:30 p.m. on the 4th**. The event is being organized by the Center for Deliberative Opinion Research at the University of Texas at Austin on behalf of the Vermont Department of Public Service

The object is to see what ordinary Vermonters like yourself would think about what Vermont should do to meet its future electricity needs if they had a chance to learn, think, and talk a lot more about the issues. The results will be shared with the Department of Public Service, which is sponsoring the event, as well as the state legislature and the Governor’s office. It’s a chance to make your voice heard.

Don’t worry if you haven’t thought much about these issues before. We’ll provide some information about the options and the arguments for and against them. It’s very important to us to get a picture of what *all* Vermonters would think about these issues when they’ve had the chance of thinking, learning, and talking about them. Participants in past Deliberative Polls have found them extremely interesting and enjoyable. We hope that you will be able to take part in this exciting and important event.

We understand of course if you need some time to think about this opportunity, but I wonder if you could tell me if you would ...

Definitely be interested in attending this event

Possibly be interested in attending

Or definitely not be interested in attending.

IF DEFINITELY YES,

That's great!!! We're delighted to have you. We'll be back in touch to provide you with all the practical information you'll need. If you have any questions, you're most welcome to call Steve Wark at the Vermont Department of Public Service (802-828-2811) or Nick Hundley at the Center for Deliberative Opinion Research (512-471-7209). Could we get your address to mail you some materials for the event?

IF POSSIBLY,

That's great!!! We're delighted you'll consider it. We'll be back in touch to provide you with all the practical information you'll need and see if you have any questions we can answer. We very much hope you'll attend. Do you have an address where we could send you some materials about the event? In the meantime, if you have any questions, please feel free to call Steve Wark at the Vermont Department of Public Service (802-828-2811) or Nick Hundley at the Center for Deliberative Opinion Research (512-471-7209)

IF NO,

Oh, that's too bad! I want to thank you for your time in responding to this interview. If you change your mind about participating in the weekend event on November 3-4 or if you have any questions about it, please feel free to call Steve Wark at the Vermont Department of Public Service (802-828-2811) or Nick Hundley at the Center for Deliberative Opinion Research (512-471-7209).